

OPERATION CAJUN SHIELD

Build a Business Solution with Plan Designer

Flood Response Mission Tracking · Half-Day Group Activity

EXERCISE — TRAINING USE ONLY · All units, names, and contacts are notional

How the day runs

1

Phase 1 — Discovery

45 min

Define the problem, the users, and what the system has to hold. Laptops closed.

2

Phase 2 — Design

70 min

Map the workflows, the agent, the reporting, and the degraded-ops fallback.

3

Phase 3 — Build

2 hr

Generate the solution in Plan Designer, then explore what it produced.

4

After Action Review

30 min

What worked, what didn't, what you'd take back to your shop.

What you'll be able to do by the end of today

1

Break down a mission problem

Take a real operational pain point and identify what a system has to do about it.

2

Define roles and access

Say who touches the system, what each one needs, and what they must not see.

3

Design the automation

Turn battle rhythm and escalation into trigger-and-action pairs a machine can run.

4

Build it in Plan Designer

Generate a working Power Platform solution from your own written description.

PHASE 1

Discovery

Four questions. Laptops closed. 45 minutes.

THE SITUATION

Operation CAJUN SHIELD

Seventy-two hours of rainfall across the Amite and Comite basins has put seven parishes under a declared state of emergency. The Governor has activated the Louisiana National Guard under State Active Duty. JFHQ-LA has stood up a Joint Task Force and is running ESF-16 Military Support from the Joint Operations Center.

7

parishes
affected

1,400+

Guardsmen
on SAD

160

high-water
vehicles

44

rescue
boats

3

rotary-wing
w/ hoist

Your team is the JTF staff cell asked to fix how mission requests are tracked — while the operation is running.

DISCUSSION QUESTION 1

What problem are we actually solving?

Current state — how mission requests are handled today

Four uncoordinated channels

Requests arrive by phone, email, radio, and WebEOC. No single system of record.

Missions lost at shift change

The 0600 / 1800 handover is verbal and a whiteboard photo. Things fall off.

No consistent intake

Requests show up with no grid, no access route, no callback number.

No common operating picture

Nobody can say how many boats are uncommitted right now.

Parishes re-request blind

They can't see status, so they call a second channel. Duplicate tasking.

Storyboard built by hand

The 0500 and 1700 storyboard takes 90 minutes to compile and is stale on arrival.

DISCUSSION QUESTION 2

Who touches this system?

1 JOC Watch NCO Internal
Receives, logs, and validates every incoming mission request.

2 J3 Battle Captain Internal
Prioritizes, assigns to units, tracks execution, escalates.

3 Task Force Commander Internal · mobile
Receives tasking and updates status from the field. On a phone. In the water.

4 Parish Emergency Manager EXTERNAL
Submits requests for their parish and checks status.

5 JTF Commander / TAG Internal · read-only
Needs one screen that answers: where are we, what's committed, what's left.

The internal / external split is what decides app type. Ask: which of these people has a state Guard account?

EXERCISE — TRAINING USE ONLY

DISCUSSION QUESTION 3

What does the system have to hold?

MISSION REQUEST

Mission number · requesting parish · type · priority · grid / location · water depth · access route · requested arrival · status · assigned unit · assigned assets · results · closeout time

PARISH

Parish name · OHSEP point of contact · EOC location · declaration status · liaison assigned

UNIT / TASK FORCE

Unit designation · parent command · commander · current location · duty status · assigned strength

ASSET

Asset type · bumper number · owning unit · capability (fording depth, pax) · status · current location

PERSONNEL

Name · rank · unit · duty status (SAD / T32 / T10) · report date · release date · accountability

You have already designed this table

The ICS 213RR Resource Request is the paper version of the Mission Request table. The form is the schema.

ICS 213RR BLOCK		YOUR DATAVERSE COLUMN
Block 1 — Incident name	→	Operation / incident
Block 3 — Request number	→	Mission number (auto)
Block 4 — Qty, kind, type	→	Asset type + quantity
Block 5 — Delivery location	→	Grid / reporting location
Block 7 — Requested by	→	Requesting parish + POC
Block 8 — Priority	→	Priority choice field
Block 9 — Section chief approval	→	Validated by / status
Block 13 — Notes	→	Remarks

What does each person actually open?

MODEL-DRIVEN APP	CANVAS APP — MOBILE	POWER PAGES PORTAL	DASHBOARD
Watch NCO · Battle Captain	Task Force Commander	Parish Emergency Manager	JTF Commander / TAG
Many records, queues, views, filters, dashboards. The JOC floor.	One thumb, bad signal, gloves on. Three taps to update status.	No Guard account. Submit a request, see only your parish's status.	One screen. Committed vs available. Open by priority. No drilling.

PHASE 2

Design

Workflows, escalation, agent, reporting, and what happens when the network dies.

What should happen without anyone remembering?

Write every one as a trigger and an action. If you can't say it in that shape, it isn't ready.

WHEN Request arrives from a parish portal → Notify JOC watch · assign mission number · acknowledge to the parish

WHEN Mission validated and assigned → Notify the task force commander AND the requesting parish

WHEN Status set to Complete → Notify the parish · roll results into the running totals

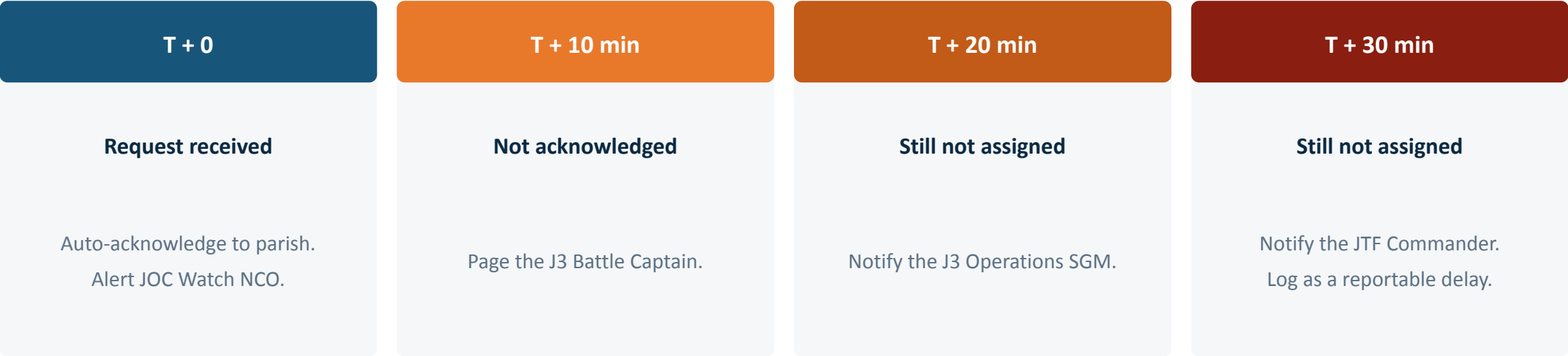
WHEN No status update in 4 hours → Flag the mission stale · notify the TF commander, then the Battle Captain

WHEN Shift change at 0600 / 1800 → Generate the handover packet — open missions, committed assets, stale items

WHEN Asset goes deadlined → Notify support operations · flag every mission that asset is committed to

Escalation: when 'urgent' means somebody is on a roof

Immediate life-safety missions need a timer and a named next person — not a hope that somebody notices.



Your team sets the clock. Defend the numbers you pick.

Does a conversation beat a form here?

PARISH INTAKE AGENT

On the parish portal. Instead of a static form, it asks the questions a dispatcher would ask:

- How many people, and where exactly?
- How deep is the water at the access point?
- Is the road passable? Which route?
- Anyone injured or medically fragile?
- Animals or livestock on site?
- Best callback number right now?

COMMANDER QUERY AGENT

Plain-language questions against live mission data, without opening a report:

“How many boats are uncommitted in Region 2?”

“Which Immediate missions are past 30 minutes?”

“What is Livingston Parish still waiting on?”

“Which units are under 80 percent accountability?”

What does the Commander need at 0500?

1

Open missions

By status and by parish. Who is waiting, and for what.

2

Asset availability

Committed vs available by type. The boats question, answered.

3

Personnel accountability

Assigned, present, and duty status by unit.

4

Response time by priority

Are we meeting the standard on Immediate missions?

5

Cumulative results

Rescues, assists, commodities, sandbags. The storyboard numbers.

For every metric, answer this: which columns produce that number? If the column isn't on your table, the report can't exist.

What happens when the network goes down?

It will. Build the degraded mode on purpose instead of discovering it at 0200.

P

PRIMARY

Mission Tracker app over the state network or cellular data.

A

ALTERNATE

Parish portal over any commercial internet; JOC works from the model-driven app.

C

CONTINGENCY

Voice or radio to the JOC. Watch NCO enters the mission on the requester's behalf.

E

EMERGENCY

Paper ICS 213RR by runner or radio relay. Back-entered when connectivity returns.

Design question: when the system comes back up, who reconciles the paper against the database — and how do you stop double-tasking in the meantime?

GROUP ACTIVITY

Document your solution design

Before anyone opens a browser, complete the Solution Design Worksheet as a team. You will write your prompt directly from it.

- Section A — Workflows and escalation timers
- Section B — Agent scenario, or a defended decision not to
- Section C — Reporting metrics and who reads them
- Section D — PACE fallback and reconciliation

45 minutes • then a 10-minute share-out

PHASE 3

Build

You've done the hard thinking. Now let the tool do the typing.

Describe the problem

- Sign in at make.powerapps.com and confirm your environment.
- Start a new plan. Your instructor will show today's exact path.
- Type your description in plain language — no special syntax.
- Optionally attach an image: a process diagram, a 213RR, a screenshot.
- If you attach one, say what it is and tell the tool to use it.
- Select Generate.

YOUR DESCRIPTION SHOULD CONTAIN

- The problem, in two sentences
- Every user role, and what each one does
- The app type for each role
- Your tables, columns, and choice values spelled out
- How the tables relate to each other
- Each workflow as a trigger and an action
- The agent, and what it is for
- The reporting metrics you need

Review what it proposed — and argue with it

The tool works in stages and stops for your approval at each one. That's your chance to correct it.

1

User requirements

Roles and user needs, with a diagram. Check: do these match the five roles you defined?

2

Data model

Tables, columns, relationships. Check: are your choice values there? Your closeout time?

3

Technology proposal

Which apps, flows, sites, agents. Check: did the parish get a portal? Is the field app mobile?

4

Save tables

Name the solution and save. Now you can build the artifacts.

Refine in plain language: “Add a water depth column to the mission request table.” · “Make the task force commander app mobile-first.”

Build the pieces and go look at them

Create each artifact from its tile. Then open every one and check it against your worksheet.

Canvas app

Screens per table, wired to data. Does the field app work on a phone?

Model-driven app

Tables pre-added. Are the JOC views right? Can you filter by priority?

Power Pages site

Pages tailored to the problem. May not generate — permissions.

Power Automate flows

Prefilled from your description. Open one and read the trigger.

Copilot Studio agent

Name, instructions, and your tables as knowledge. No triggers yet.

Data diagram

The ERD. Does it match what your team drew on paper?

Nothing publishes itself. Every artifact you get is a starting point that still needs finishing, testing, and approval.

GROUP ACTIVITY

Build your solution

- Driver shares screen. One editor per plan — everyone else reviews.
- Write the description straight from your worksheet.
- Work the approval gates. Correct the tool at each one.
- Save tables, then create the artifacts.
- Open every artifact and check it against Section A through D.
- Fill in your AAR sheet while it's fresh — before we talk.

90 minutes

After Action Review

SUSTAIN

- What did it build that you didn't expect?
- Where would this save the most time on a real activation?
- What part of your design came through exactly right?

IMPROVE

- Where did it fall short of your design?
- What would you still have to build by hand?
- How would you rewrite your description?

THE THREE TAKEAWAYS

1

The description is the system.

Specific teams got specific results. Vague teams got generic ones. You saw the exchange rate.

2

This is a starting point.

Customization, security, accreditation, testing, and approval to operate are all still yours.

3

The thinking transfers.

Roles, data, trigger-and-action, metrics before build, PACE. Those work on any tool.

OPERATION CAJUN SHIELD

The description is the system.

Take your worksheet with you. It's a requirement document, and it's good on any tool.

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